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LEARNING THROUGH PLAY

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7.1 INTRODUCTION

Play is a fundamental aspect of childhood with profound implications for learning and development. Children learn best when they are actively engaged and invested in what they are doing. Play naturally fosters this engagement as it turns these routine moments into meaningful learning experiences. In the foundational years, learning is most effective when children learn in natural ways as they explore, interact and make sense of the world around them.

Isn't it more effective for a mother to teach her child everyday tasks through playful activities rather than direct instruction? For instance, tidying up can become a game of "sorting colours" or "beat the clock," where a child can happily learn to organise toys. Similarly, setting the table can turn into a fun role-play scenario like "playing restaurant," helping the child understand responsibility while enjoying the process. Through such playful engagement, everyday activities become opportunities for learning, cooperation, and skill-

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building without pressure.

The National Curriculum Framework for the Foundational Stage (NCF-FS, 2022) places play at the heart of early learning, emphasising its centrality in fostering holistic development. It views play not as a break from learning, but as learning itself. Whether it is physical play, social interaction, symbolic make-believe, or constructive activity, each form contributes to the development of foundational literacy and numeracy among children.

For in-service teachers, this means creating classroom environments that are inclusive, engaging, and responsive to children's natural ways of learning. By integrating play into daily routines and lesson plans, teachers can help children build skills and confidence without pressure, while nurturing their curiosity and creativity.

This chapter examines various methods of learning through play. It highlights how such approaches, aligned with national curricular goals, can transform early learning into a joyful and meaningful journey for every child.

**7.2 LEARNING OUTCOMES**

After completion of this chapter, the learner

- recognises the importance of play-based learning at the preparatory stage;
- illustrates different forms of play-based learning for language skills and numeracy concepts;
- interprets effective use of conversation and storytelling to support language development, listening skills, and language acquisition;
- creates art and craft activities for encouraging creativity and integrating different concepts of literacy and numeracy; and
- designs a play-based learning plan integrating different methods.

7.3 CONCEPT OF PLAY

Children and adults too, learn best when they are actively engaged in meaningful, enjoyable activities that are self-directed, imaginative, and exploratory. When learners immerse themselves in activities that are meaningful and enjoyable,

they do not just absorb information but also interact, question, and integrate it into their pre-existing knowledge. This allows them to be the owners of their learning.

Instead of learning through direct instruction or rote memorisation, this approach emphasises learning that happens naturally as a result of playful engagement with the world.

Learning through play becomes easy because of the following factors:

- **Active Engagement**

Children are not merely passive recipients of information. Instead, they actively engage with their surroundings when they manipulate objects, explore environments, and interact with others. This strengthens their cognitive and motor skills.

- **Intrinsic Motivation**

Play is done for its own sake. When children engage in play, they do so because they are naturally curious. They do not seek to earn rewards or meet external expectations. Most of the time, play is intrinsically motivated. They want to explore their environment and learn about the world, and in the process, they learn about themselves.

- **Imagination and Creativity**

Play encourages abstract thinking, imagination, role-playing and problem-solving among children. These skills help them develop flexible and innovative thinking.

- **Social Interaction**

Different forms of play facilitate not only enjoyment but also help in the development of vital social and emotional skills. Play involving collaboration, negotiation, turn-taking fosters empathy as they learn to understand and respect each other's perspectives and feelings. These are crucial for their personal development and interpersonal relationships.

- **Iterative Learning**

Through play, children test various hypotheses, make mistakes and engage in trial and error. This process mirrors scientific inquiry. As they navigate challenges and adapt strategies, they develop resilience and



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cultivate adaptive thinking skills.

- **Relevance and Meaning**

Play is often based on real-life experiences or interests. When learning is meaningful to the child, retention and understanding improve.

7.4 PRINCIPLES OF PLAY

Principles of pedagogy underlie all decisions related to teaching strategies in the classroom appropriate for the Foundational Stage. The following principles inform classroom planning and instruction:

1. A safe and stimulating environment is fundamental to development and learning at this stage.
 - Activities are joyful and encourage the use of all the child's senses.
 - Classrooms provide variety and challenge.
 - Physical and emotional safety is paramount while making pedagogical choices.
 - Classrooms are clean, cheerful, well-ventilated, and well-lit learning spaces.
2. Play is central to learning and development at this stage.
 - Play can be free, guided, or structured.
 - Conversations, stories, music, movement, arts, crafts, toys and games are part of play, and of the methods to engage children in play - other methods could be innovated.
 - Outdoor play is actively encouraged.
3. Nurturing relationships between the teacher and the child is the basis of teaching and learning.
 - Listening carefully to children and 'being with them' entirely is essential.
4. Physical development is crucial at this stage.
 - Classroom activities encourage gross and fine motor skills and physical movement in children
 - This also helps in the socio-emotional and cognitive development.
5. Every child learns at their own pace, and learning needs are addressed individually.

- Different children respond to the same situation differently.
 - The same child may, at different times, respond differently to similar situations.
 - Opportunities are provided for all children to participate in the classroom in ways that suit each child best.
6. Children at the Foundational Stage are most comfortable and learn best in their home language.
 - i. The language of instruction and transaction is the child's home language/mother tongue or any familiar language.
 - ii. Use of home languages is celebrated and encouraged in the classroom.
 - iii. Transition into school languages, when different from home languages, is gentle and always scaffolded by the home language.
 - iv. Children are encouraged to express themselves as much as possible and never judged or reprimanded for the language that they speak.
 7. Learning experiences in the classroom are deeply connected to children's lives and their contexts.
 - i. Local stories, rhymes, songs, games, crafts, and materials are used extensively.
 - ii. Children's home language is welcomed and indeed encouraged in the classroom.
 8. Learning experiences are designed to build on children's previous understanding.
 - i. Planning moves from simple to complex ideas and concepts based on this principle.
 - ii. Using the home language facilitates this
 9. Classroom processes address all domains of development.
 - a) Balance is maintained between activities pertaining to physical development, socio-emotional and ethical development, cognitive development, aesthetic and cultural development.



- i.learn best when they are actively engaged in meaningful, enjoyable activities that are self-directed, imaginative, and exploratory.

a) Children

b) adults

c) seniors
- ii. Children at the.....stage is most comfortable and learn best in their home language.

a) Foundational

b) Secondary

c) Senior Secondary
- iii. In.....engagement children are not merely passive recipients of information.

a) home

b) classroom

c) active
- iv. Play should be based on.....life experiences to make learning meaningful to the child.

a) new

b) real

c) artificial
- v.experiences are designed to build on children's previous understanding.

a) activity

b) learning

c) play

Explain the role of play in enhancing imagination and creativity among the learners.

- i. Children
- ii. Foundational
- iii. Active
- iv. Real
- v. Learning

7.5 LEARNING THROUGH PLAY: CONCEPT AND STRATEGIES FOR LITERACY AND NUMERACY**Curriculum Transaction****7.5.1 Conversations as Tool for Learning**

Conversations are a significant part of learning through play in the early years of development. Children connect with the world by interacting with objects and building a connection with their environment. These interactions help them make connections, develop trust, and gain confidence — factors that are essential for fostering language development.

According to NCF-FS 2022, conversations in the classroom can be of two kinds:

Free conversations: *The teacher gathers a few children and encourages them to talk about events from their day, their journey to school, or anything they wish to share. The teacher uses simple prompts to help children express their experiences.*

Structured conversations: *These are planned by the teacher, usually during morning assembly time, to engage children in thinking and talking about familiar topics such as daily events, routines, or their feelings.*

The teacher can plan a conversation activity in a free or a structured form. In the free form, the teacher may ask some students to talk about their day-to-day experiences, experiences related to their school, home, and friends. In a structured format, the students are engaged in thinking and talking about familiar topics.

The teacher planned a picture-talking activity to develop students' speaking and listening skills.

Classroom Activity:**a) Picture Talking**

(Source: Hindi Text book for class 3: Veena, pp 82-83, NCERT, April 2024)

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Richa, the teacher of II class, has initiated the activity with the students by showing a picture in the classroom and asking guided question prompts along with a discussion with the children to allow them to relate to the image, recall their own experience and spark interest in the conversation.

Question prompts and answers:

Richa asks Bindi, “What do you see in the picture?”

Bindi replied, “Some children.”

Richa asked, “How many children can you see on both sides?”

Anil replied, “Five children are on each side.”

Then Richa asks, “What are the children doing?”

Rekha replied that they are playing a game of ‘tug of war’.

Richa asked, “Have you ever played this game?”

Nadeem and Sonali said “yes, we played this game”, but Rajani said, “No, she haven’t played this game”.

Richa asks Nadeem and Sonali to share their experiences with their classmates.

This activity encourages children to observe and describe what they see, building vocabulary and oral expression, and also promoting reasoning with classroom interactions with prompts such as, “Why there is an equal number of children on both sides”, in a fun, interactive, and easy manner.

The teacher can conduct similar activities like this in the class. Some examples of these types of activities are discussed here:

b) Pass the Bag

Add different objects in the bag related to the child’s classroom or home environment, such as a ball, a toothbrush, a small biscuit box and even objects/ toys from a kitchen set.

Guided question prompts by the teacher will help children to participate in the activity joyfully.

(Objects chosen for the bag are the ones that a children may come across in their daily routines. This will help children relate, recall, and share their own



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experiences.)

This activity builds language and thinking together through playful, everyday contexts and also develops conceptual understanding (e.g., shapes, textures) in meaningful ways.

c) Setting up a vegetable market in the classroom with the help of low-cost teaching aids

In this activity, the teacher sets up a vegetable market in the classroom where children engage in pretend play as shopkeepers and customers. Various fruits, vegetables (real or toy, depending on the class level) - are displayed with labels that include both the name of the item and its price (e.g., “Apple – ₹5”). Children use money to buy and sell items.

Guided question prompts by the teacher during the activity will enhance children’s participation and build conversations through play. Questions such as -

What would you like to buy?

What is the name of this vegetable?

Can you help me read the price tag?

How many apples do you want to buy?

Which is cheaper, apples or bananas?

How many items are now in your shopping bag?

This immersive play-based experience not only reinforces foundational literacy and numeracy skills but also builds confidence, communication abilities, and real-world understanding through play.



CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 7.2

1. Conversations are a significant part ofthrough play in the early years of development.
a) teaching b) learning c) doing
2. Inconversations, the teacher uses simple prompts to help children express their experiences.
a) free b) structured c) simple

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- 3activity builds vocabulary and oral expression, and also promotes reasoning with classroom interactions.
 - a) Picture Talking b) guided question c) free thinking
4.Conversations are planned by the teacher, usually during morning assembly time.
 - a) Structured b) free c) Mixed
5. Select any picture for picture talking activity from your textbook and prepare the questions for conversation to be initiated by you in the classroom.

Answer : 1 - b; 2 - b; 3 - a; 4 - a

7.5.2 Stories as Tool for Learning

According to the NCF-FS 2022, storytelling is a key play-based approach that supports the development of language, imagination, and thinking skills in young children. It helps build listening, speaking, and comprehension abilities and can also introduce concepts like sequence, logic, and quantity in an easy and joyful context.

Storytelling encourages active participation, making learning engaging and rooted in children's everyday experiences. Stories are a window to the world for children. They are fascinating, beautiful, and enchanting! Listening to stories is great fun, and young children, particularly, love to hear them. Stories told with feeling, with gestures and animated expressions, are magical and take your breath away. Every word becomes an experience in itself.

Stories are a perfect medium for learning about social relationships, ethical choices, understanding and experiencing emotions, and developing life skills. Children's vocabulary grows as they listen to stories, and they also pick up problem-solving techniques and sentence structure. When immersed in a story, children with extremely short attention spans focus for longer periods. Youngsters can be introduced to their culture, social mores, and environment through culturally relevant stories. Young children enjoy hearing the same story repeatedly. They eventually understand the material better and retain it when it is reinforced.

They become more engaged with the story's characters, events, and ideas, as well as their vocabulary and imagination, when they hear the same story repeatedly in various formats. The teacher should be well-versed in the story

when narrating it orally. Voice modulation and facial expressions should be used when telling stories. Children can visualise and engage with the events that are being told through a well-told story.

Stories can be told using puppets, either pre-made or created by the teacher with the help of the students. Stories can also be told using flashcards with story scenes printed or illustrated on them. They might be easy to hold and bigger than a book. Flash cards serve as sequence cards to be given to children to organise in the correct order. Besides these, story charts, posters and other storytelling aids are available in the market or can be created.

Children must also have the opportunity to tell stories. Stories told by children can be the same ones they have heard or their creations. The teacher can begin to tell a story and ask children to complete it. Selecting the right story is critical.

- Stories should be age-appropriate, in familiar language, and should be of interest to children.
- Stories could be connected to whatever else is being taught in the classroom, e.g., counting, shapes or colours.
- Stories could also be used to reinforce essential learning objectives, such as sensitivity to others and good work habits.

To maximise relevance and relatability, they should be as deeply anchored in the local or Indian context as feasible. Indeed, we can learn a lot about many fundamental values and the value of relationships from the people and stories of India's long history and tradition. The original Panchatantra, Jataka, Hitopadesha, and other entertaining fables and motivational tales from Indian tradition should be made available to children for them to read, hear, and learn from.

Following a story, the teacher could assess the students' comprehension of the narrative's subject matter. Questions about what, whom, why, where, how, and what if can be posed by the teacher. As the kids get a little older, the teacher can talk about right and wrong behaviour, explain why a character acted in a particular way, and explain the consequences. Drawing could be another follow-up exercise. Youngsters can illustrate a scene or a character from the narrative. Other follow-up exercises include role-playing and dramatisation.



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Classroom Activity -

a) Storytelling through picture sequencing



(Source: English Text book for class 1: Mridang, pp. 54-56, NCERT, May, 2023)

As the teacher enters the class, the teacher first sets the background of the story to spark interest in the storytelling session. The teacher starts narrating the story with the help of picture cards. Once there was a cap seller who sold beautiful caps. One hot day, the cap seller was going to sell his caps at a village market. As it was a hot day, he got tired in the heat of the sun and thought of taking a rest for a while, under a tree and the monkeys in the tree took all of the caps from his basket. When he woke up, he saw the monkeys wearing the caps. He realised the monkeys were imitating him, so he threw a cap on the ground. The monkeys copied him and threw their caps down, allowing the cap seller to collect them and continue on his journey.

After the completion of the story, the teacher can initiate the conversation by asking the students, “Did you enjoy the story?” The students responded, “Yes, we enjoyed.” The teacher asked, “Surbhi, what part did you like the most?” Surbhi responded, “When the monkeys in the tree took all of the caps from his basket.”



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The teacher can engage students in other activities based on storytelling-

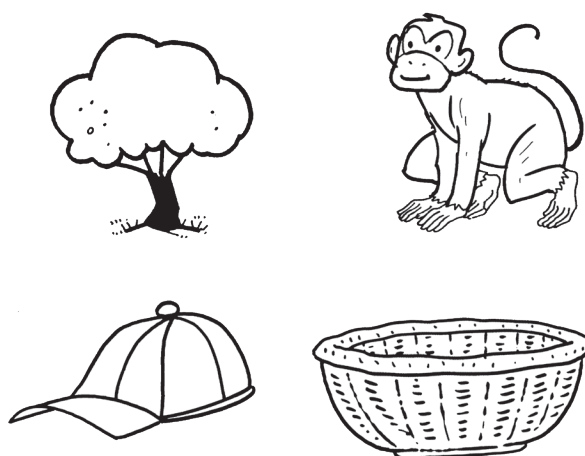
b) Reorder in correct sequence



(Source: English Text book for class 1: Mridang, page 58, NCERT, May, 2023)

Thinking and pondering over which event happened first in the story will help children understand the structure of a story (beginning, middle, end) and sequencing the story will help them assign numbers to the story scenes. This, in turn, will help children develop comprehension, analyse pictures, notice details, and explain the order.

c) Together, let's write



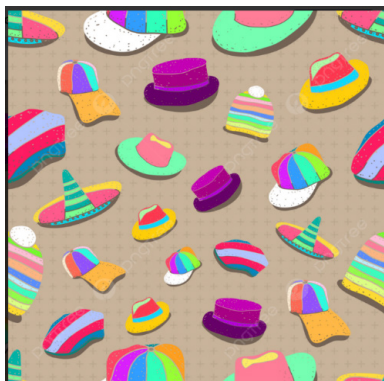
(Source: English Text book for class 1: Mridang, page 59, NCERT, May, 2023)

Here, children look at the pictures — each one representing a central object or character from the story. Each image is labelled, and children are encouraged to say the word aloud and write it in the blank space.

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d) Cap Sorting Activity



The teacher shows the image to the class and can use the following question prompts- Write how many caps you find in the picture-





e) My world-

Giving students a chance to think of an alternate situation not only helps in language development but also boosts cognitive skills.

Thinking prompts-

- The teacher can ask the students, “What else could the cap-seller have done?” The students may respond **by throwing empty caps or leaves, feigning a reaction, or by distraction, etc.**
- The teacher can ask the students, “Would you like to replace caps with anything else?” The students may respond I would like to replace caps with colourful balls.

**CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 7.3**

- 1 What is the primary purpose of the storytelling method in education?
 - a) To test students' factual recall



- b) To make learning more engaging and memorable
 - c) To promote rote memorisation
 - d) To teach students how to write stories
2. Which of the following is NOT a benefit of using the storytelling method?
- a) Enhanced creativity
 - b) Increased student engagement
 - c) Improved memory retention
 - d) Reduced student participation in class discussions
3.are a perfect medium for learning about social relationships, ethical choices, understanding and experiencing emotions, and developing life skills.
- a) Stories b) Toys c) conversation
4.encourages active participation, making learning engaging and rooted in children's everyday experiences.
- a) Storytelling b) gaming c) playing

7.5.3 Toys as a Tool for Learning

This subset of play-based pedagogy is significant. The NCF-FS 2022 highlights the importance of using toys as powerful tools for learning in early childhood. It recognises that toys make learning joyful, engaging, and meaningful by encouraging children to explore, imagine, and create. Through play with toys, children develop essential skills across all domains—thinking, language, movement, and social interaction.

Young children learn best when they work with real objects and have first-hand experiences. They experiment, investigate, and gain knowledge. Playing with toys and manipulatives should foster this spirit of exploration in the classroom. Every child's environment has a variety of local toys. This ought to be utilised as a valuable teaching and learning tool. Every toy has a lesson for the child to learn, regardless of its simplicity or complexity. A child's hand-eye coordination is strengthened and their motor skills are practised when they manipulate a toy. The development of children is greatly aided by toys that require them to push, pull, grab, pinch, turn, or use their hands and bodies in other ways.

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A child learns concepts and considers a way to prevent the fall when she constructs a tower out of blocks and eventually watches it fall to the ground. A puzzle facilitates a child's investigation of patterns. Children begin to make up stories and act out scenarios in their minds when they use pretend toys, dolls, blocks, balls, mini-cars, or animal toys. Playing board games helps kids learn basic rules and improves their language and mathematics skills. Puzzles encourage experimentation with cause and effect, strategic thinking and problem-solving. The use of craft materials such as clay, beads, collage materials, paint, washable inkpads and stamps, washable markers, and scissors supports creative expression and aesthetic awareness.

Complex construction sets and accessories allow children to experiment with how things fit and work together, increase their fine motor skills, and express their creativity. Fitness and fun materials such as balls, beanbags and jump ropes help children gain self-confidence, exercise, release tension, have fun with others, and develop fine and gross motor skills.

Examples of toys are:

- a) **Ring Set Puzzle:** This is a wooden set of serrated rings. Crafted in Channapatna, Karnataka, it aids in the development of fine and gross motor skills, colour and shape awareness, and seriation.
- b) **Dhingli,** or cotton dolls, are a type of traditional Gujarati toy doll. It is composed of cotton and embellished with embroidered fabric in a variety of eye-catching hues, including red, blue, green, and yellow. There are two sizes of these dolls: small and large. In addition to being used for dramatic play, very young children use them to feel safe while napping.
- c) **Rasoi (Kitchen Set):** In many regions of India, children play with a set of kitchen utensils called Rasoi.

Teachers can use various toys to help students learn the concepts of numeracy and literacy and develop critical skills.

Activities with different toys used-

1. Wooden Blocks



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Begin with a short story or visual prompt: “Today, we’re going to build our castles. Are you ready to create your castle?”

Distribute wooden blocks to each child/group.

Ask them to build their castles using the blocks.

Also, encourage them to experiment with different shapes and heights.

As children build, ask questions like:

- What shape is the base of your castle?
- Can you make a tower with the triangle blocks?
- How many blocks did you use?
- After the castle-making activity, conversation prompts such as
- Who lives in your castle?
- Can you tell me about the different parts of your castle?
- What is special or magical about your castle?

2. Teachers can use various toys to help students learn the concepts of numeracy and literacy, and develop critical skills.

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How Many Blocks?

Fill in the blanks.

- The giraffe is _____ blocks tall.
- The _____ is 7 blocks tall.
- The monkey is _____ blocks tall.
- The elephant is _____ blocks tall.

(Source – Mathematics Text book for class 2: Joyful Mathematics, NCERT, May 2023, page 74)

In this activity, the teacher is using toys to make students learn the concept of numbers.

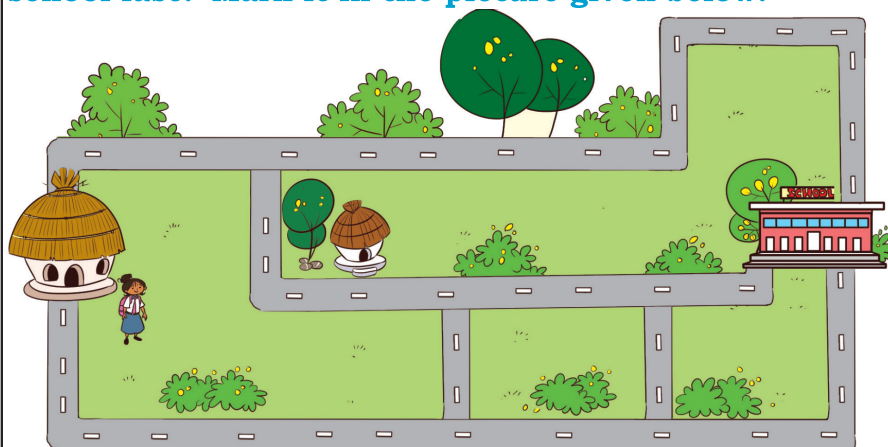


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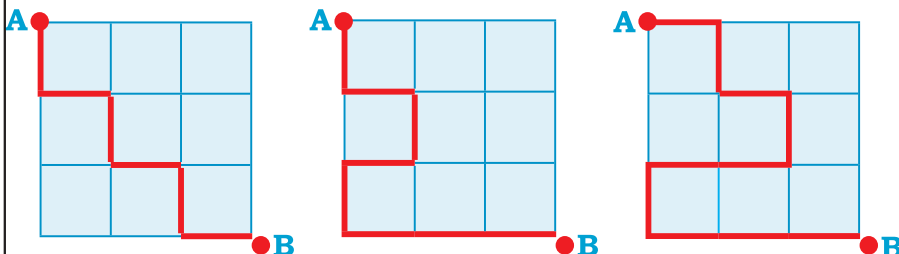
Let us Do

Kavita is going to the school from her home. She is getting late. Which path should she use to reach the school fast? Mark it in the picture given below.



Let us Do

Choose the longest path from A to B.



Also make the shortest path between A and B.

Encourage children to verify their choice of path using a thread. Ask them to help each other in measuring the length.



(Source – Mathematic Text book for class 2 : Joyful Mathematics, NCERT, May 2023, page 73)

This activity could be used by teachers to develop critical thinking among students.

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Notes**CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 7.4**

1. In the context of toy-based pedagogy, what does the term “holistic development” refer to?
 - a) Focusing solely on physical skills
 - b) Developing intellectual, mental, physical, emotional, and social abilities
 - c) Prioritising academic learning
 - d) Ignoring emotional and social aspects
2. What is the primary benefit of using toys in education?
 - a) It makes learning more expensive
 - b) It makes learning more fun and engaging
 - c) It distracts students from their studies
 - d) It requires a lot of teacher training
3. Which of the following is NOT a life skill that can be learned through play?
 - a) Problem-solving
 - b) Decision making
 - c) Emotional regulation
 - d) Memorizing facts
4. Playing with toys fosters the spirit of exploration in the classroom. Reflect on the statement with suitable examples.
5. A child’s hand-eye coordination is strengthened and their motor skills are practised when the child manipulates a toy. Explain the usefulness of manipulatives for physical and cognitive development with suitable examples.

Answers: 1 - b; 2 - b; 3 - d

7.5.4 Music as a Tool for Learning

Music brings happiness. Children hear grandmothers' humming and lullabies as they grow up. A farmer singing in the field, bees buzzing, koyal cooing, or rain pattering on a window are just a few of the many musical sources that surround us. Additionally, the development of the brain and the creation of synaptic connections are strongly stimulated by music. Therefore, singing, playing simple instruments, and keeping time with the beat should all be promoted. Claps and rhythms played on a tin box, khanjari (tambourine), or manjira (cymbals) can be accompanied by body movements.

There are different ways to use songs. The teacher can sing a song and have the children repeat it. Body language, gestures, and actions may accompany this. Additionally, the kids can sing songs alone, in groups, or in pairs. Children can play a quick game to figure out the melody of a well-known song while the teacher sings it. Youngsters can hum the melody of various songs without the lyrics. Songs that have already been learned can be sung by the teacher and the students in multiple tunes. Youngsters can be inspired to compose simple songs. This may be accompanied by actions, gestures, and body language. While the teacher sings a well-known song, the kids can play a quick game where they have to guess the melody. Children can be encouraged to write simple songs.

Children should have access to a variety of instruments, whether they are handmade, locally sourced, or purchased, so they can experiment with sound and create music firsthand. For children to hear and perform in the classroom, teachers could incorporate a range of music, dances, sound sources, rhymes, chants, and songs with various moods, contexts, and languages. Children can learn musical concepts through finger plays, folk songs, action songs, dancing, singing, and rhymes. Music and rhymes also play a critical role in developing literacy and numeracy skills in early childhood.

As per NCF FS 2022 - Songs, rhymes, and rhythms are not only culturally rooted and joyful but are also foundational to the development of oral language, early literacy, and numeracy skills. They offer an immersive and playful pathway to concept formation and communication.

Songs, rhymes, and rhythms play an important role in developing children's connection to language, literacy, and numeracy skills. These musical elements provide a fun and engaging way for children to learn, fostering concept formation and communication abilities.

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1. Foundational for Oral Language:

- It helps to expand vocabulary among the students.
- Rhythms and rhymes help children develop phonological awareness
- Exposure to song lyrics and repetitive phrases in rhymes helps children grasp sentence structure and syntax.

2. Early Literacy Skills:

- The phonological awareness skills developed through rhymes are crucial for learning to read.
- The predictable patterns in rhymes and songs enhance memory skills and help children learn to sequence events or ideas.

3. Numeracy Skills:

Songs and rhymes like “Two Little Hands” directly teach counting and number recognition.

The musical elements act as powerful tools for language acquisition, literacy and numeracy development, and the broader cognitive and social-emotional growth of young children. The teacher can organise these activities in the class; some examples related to these activities are:

1. Learning with rhymes

The teacher recites the following poem using voice modulation, hand gestures and rhythm.

Two Little Hands

Two little hands go clap, clap, clap.

Two little legs go tap, tap, tap.

Two little eyes are open wide.

One little head goes side to side.

Two little eyes to look around.

Two little ears to hear any sound.

One little nose to smell and breathe.

One little mouth that likes to eat. Hands to clap, legs to walk.

Nose to smell, mouth to talk.

Head to move, eyes to see.



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I have a little body that belongs to me.

The children perform corresponding actions, reinforcing word-meaning associations.

This musical rhyme helps children learn language through fun and movement. As they say lines like “I clap with my hands” and do the actions, they connect words with meaning. The rhythm and repetition make it easier to remember new words and sentence patterns. As per NCF-FS 2022, such playful and action-based activities build listening, speaking, and understanding skills naturally and joyfully.

Unit 2

Welcome to My World



Chapter 1

It is Fun



Let us recite



It's fun to be this,
It's fun to be that,
To leap like a lamb,
To climb like a cat.



Sight words

this | that | like | to |
them | all | none

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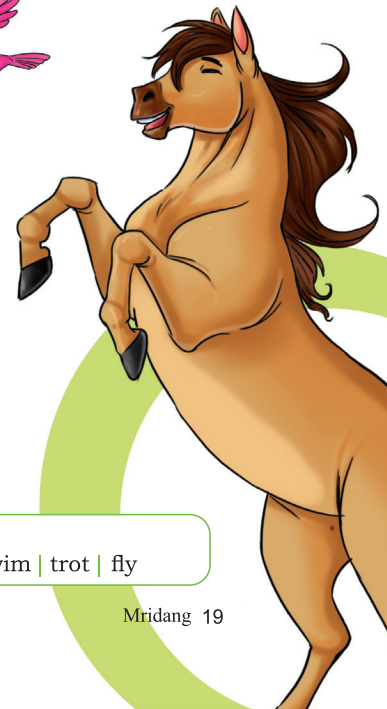
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To hop like a frog,
To swim like a fish,
To trot like a horse,
To fly like a bird.



I can act
Just like them all,
It's fun to be this,
It's fun to be that.



New words

fun | climb | leap | swim | trot | fly

Mridang 19

(Source: English Text book for class 2: Mridang, pp 18-19, NCERT, May, 2023)

The teacher can plan an activity by asking the students to recite the poems. They can also ask the students to create their short poem/rhyme and recite it in class.



CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 7.5

1. The development of the brain and the creation of synaptic connections are strongly stimulated by music. (True/False)
2. Children can learn musical concepts through finger plays, folk songs, action songs, dancing, singing, and rhymes. (True/False)
3. Which of the following is NOT a primary benefit of incorporating music into teaching?

- a) Enhanced memory and recall
 - b) Improved focus and attention
 - c) Increased physical activity
 - c) Reduced student engagement
4. What role does music play in language learning?
- a) Primarily for entertainment purposes
 - b) Only useful for vocabulary acquisition
 - c) Aids in developing listening skills, language association, and phonological skills
 - d) Has no impact on language learning

Answers: 3 - d; 4 - c

7.5.5 Art and Craft as Tool for Learning

Youngsters love experimenting with colours and making things that interest them. Art and craft provide another medium for children to express their ideas, emotions, and feelings.

The NCF-FS 2022 highlights the importance of art and craft in nurturing creativity and holistic development:

Art and craft experiences allow children to express their ideas, strengthen fine motor abilities, and connect with their cultural traditions. *(NCF-FS 2022)*

Art and craft activities are highly beneficial for children, providing them with opportunities for self-expression, developing fine motor skills, and fostering an understanding of their cultural heritage. It helps in developing self-expression and fine motor skills, cultural connection. Art and craft activities are not just recreational but also play a vital role in a child's holistic development, encompassing emotional, physical, and cognitive growth. The teacher can organise some activities as listed below:

Activity 1

The teacher asks the children to draw objects they love and things they can see around them, and write their spellings. Then they are made to read those spellings phonetically.



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(This activity promotes language development by building vocabulary, strengthening phonemic awareness, linking sounds to letters, and encouraging expressive and meaningful engagement with language).

Activity 2 (Family Tree)

Children are given a worksheet that provides space to paste pictures of their family members inside the tree. They label each family member by writing their names next to the pictures. Children can add simple descriptions or words related to their personal feelings.



The teacher supports children in writing the names and one-word feelings, connecting spoken words to written text.

The activity encourages children to talk about their family and express personal experiences. It helps develop print awareness, vocabulary, and meaningful writing skills. The craft also strengthens social-emotional connections by linking literacy to the child's identity and relationships.

- **Drawing:** Paper and crayons, sketch pens, coloured or black pencils, or charcoal can all be used for drawing. Kids can also sketch on floors, blackboards, or slates. Blackboards and the floor have the benefit of giving kids plenty of room to draw big pictures. Paper can also come in a variety of colours, sizes, and shapes. Children will create distinct and different images if they are given black paper and either white or yellow crayons instead of white paper and crayons of various colours. When young children first learn to hold crayons, they start by scribbling and then progressively progress to drawing random shapes before being able to draw precise shapes and patterns. Drawing is a valuable activity for expression as well as fine motor coordination.

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- **Painting** is experimenting with wet colour on paper, fabric, or the floor. The teacher can make brushes out of sticks and cotton or fabric, or the kids can use brushes that are sold in stores. Thumb printing, palm printing, printing with vegetable waste, and printing with other materials like bottle caps, blocks, and vegetables (like potatoes or lady fingers) are some variations of wet paint. Youngsters also like finger painting, finger printing, and thread printing. Using glue and items that adhere to paper or fabric is known as pasting. Matchsticks or colored paper can be pasted onto a shape that the teacher or kids draw, or it can be a free-form pasting exercise. Different materials like sand, pencil shavings, sawdust, dry mud, coloured, or newspaper print paper can also be pasted on paper.
- You can also make a collage with various materials. Both readily available glue and teacher-made glue can be used for the same purpose. Clay moulding can be done with potters' clay or wet mud that has been lightly glued.
- The teacher may supply dough, either with or without food colouring added. Youngsters should be encouraged to experiment with this medium and make various objects and shapes.

Using clay as a learning tool creates a multi-sensory experience for the children. When used during play, children will develop communication skills as well as creative and imaginative skills.

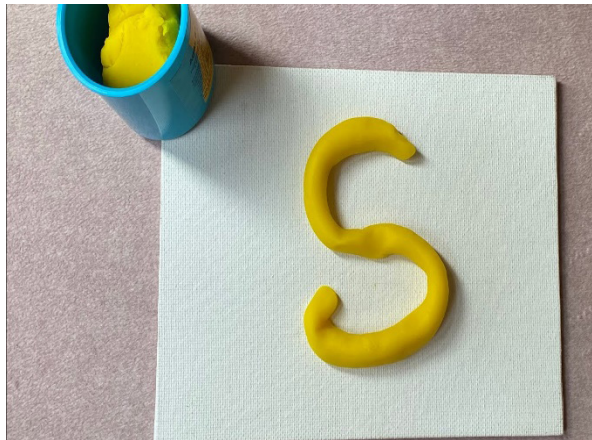
- **Activity- Letter formation with Clay**

Give each child a small ball of clay and ask them to roll it into long, thin "snakes" using their palms or fingers. Using the clay "snakes," children shape them into letters of the alphabet on a flat surface. For example, forming an S with curved pieces.

As they form each letter, say the sound of the letter together and think of a word that begins with it (e.g., "S is for Sun").

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Children can place their clay letters on a mat or tray to show to others and say the letter aloud, which helps build confidence and speaking skills.

- **Toran Activity**



- Children create a traditional decorative garland (toran) using mango leaves. They arrange the leaves in a pattern and string them together to hang above a doorway or wall. During the activity, children are encouraged to observe, count, talk about what they are doing, and explore cultural significance.
- Teacher can prompt questions such as –
 - How many leaves have you used so far?
 - Can you count the total number of leaves in your toran?
 - Can you make a pattern using big and small leaves?

This activity uses culturally rooted materials where children learn through exploration, creativity, and play.



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- **Puppets**

Activity-The teacher divides the class into small groups of 4–5 children. Each group receives one puppet. Children are encouraged to collaboratively:

- Name their puppet.
- Decide what the puppet likes.
- Describe how the puppet is feeling today (e.g., happy, sad, excited, tired).
- Talk about the puppet's favourite food, hobby, or place.



After the discussion, each group presents their puppet to the class, introducing it and sharing its story and feelings.

This activity uses puppets to enhance not only oral language skills but also develop socio-emotional learning aspects, aligning with the NCF-FS focus on holistic, play-based learning.

7.5.6 THINGS TO KEEP IN MIND DURING ARTS AND CRAFTS WORK

- Uninhibited artistic expression:** Children must be allowed to create visual arrangements, artworks, tunes, songs, role-play, dramatic play, dance, and creative movements from their imagination, as well as through guided exercises facilitated by the teacher. Notions of 'right' and 'wrong', 'good' and 'bad' in terms of artistic expression must be avoided. Instead, different viewpoints, experiences, expressions, and imaginations should be encouraged and celebrated.

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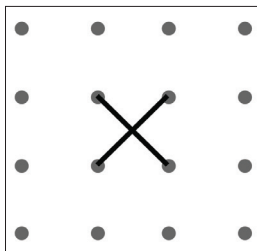
- b) Material, medium, and tool exploration:** Children must cultivate and use their curiosity by investigating a range of materials and increasing the number of ways they can be used as tools and mediums in the arts. One could use a brush as a tool in the visual arts, but it could also be used as a prop for a play or as a musical instrument. In addition to the widely recognised methods, children should be encouraged to develop their own approaches to using tools and materials in every artistic discipline.
- c) Observation:** Children must learn to be acute observers of their thoughts, feelings, emotions, expressions, actions, and general behaviour in addition to visually observing their environment. Introducing young people to the fundamentals of the arts Enables them to develop their aesthetic sensibilities and organise and comprehend multisensory stimuli using a variety of frameworks. Simple exercises that focus on movement, colour, or sound can be applied to everyday situations to help children connect these to feelings, ideas, and behaviours.
- d. Conversation and dialogue:** An inclusive atmosphere should always be maintained in the arts classroom by the teacher. The teacher needs to listen carefully to the children's spoken and unspoken communication, value their performance and visual art, and ask questions that invite each child's unique response.
- e.) Aesthetic appreciation:** Regular conversations and discussions about appreciating our individual preferences, what is valued by the group, and what is aesthetically pleasing must be a part of the art class. The practical work completed in class and artistic experiences that kids can connect to from their daily lives must serve as the foundation for these discussions (such as their preferences for festivals, performances, food, dance, colour, and attire). In these discussions, the teacher's role must be one of participation and nonjudgment. In an art class, discussions shouldn't take longer than eight to ten minutes.

An activity can be planned where the teacher can ask the students to prepare a face mask. Another activity could involve the teacher giving some dots to the students and ask them to draw a rangoli by joining the dots.

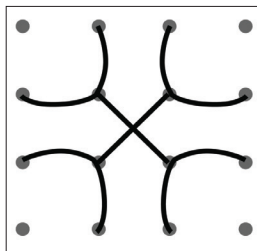
**Rangoli**

Follow the steps to draw a rangoli and colour it.

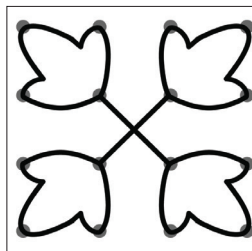
Step 1



Step 2



Step 3



(Source: English Text book for class 2: Mridang, page 26, NCERT, May, 2023)

**CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 7.6**

1. Art and craft activities in education primarily aim to:
 - a) Develop fine motor skills only
 - b) Enhance creativity and imagination
 - c) Improve academic performance in other subjects
 - d) All of the above
2. Which of the following is an example of a student-centered approach to using art and craft in teaching?
 - a) The teacher demonstrates a specific craft technique, and students replicate it.
 - b) Students choose their art materials and projects based on their interests.
 - c) The teacher assigns specific art projects based on the curriculum.
 - d) Students follow a detailed set of instructions to create a predetermined art piece.

Answers: 1 - b; 2 - b



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**7.6 LET US SUM UP**

- Play is a natural and powerful medium of learning in early childhood that fosters curiosity, imagination, and active engagement across all domains of development.
- The National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage (NCF-FS, 2022) recognizes play as central to holistic learning and encourages its integration into daily classroom experiences.
- Children benefit most from active, self-directed, joyful, and exploratory activities that promote not just academic skills but also cognitive, physical, emotional, and social development.
- Conversations—both free and structured—support language development, enhance vocabulary, build confidence, and encourage oral expression through real-life, relatable contexts.
- Storytelling enhances children’s listening, comprehension, imagination, and moral reasoning. Stories connect children to culture, develop sequencing skills, and build foundational literacy and empathy.
- Toy-based pedagogy enables children to engage in hands-on exploration and critical thinking while developing fine motor skills, numeracy, spatial awareness, and problem-solving abilities.
- Music and rhymes are joyful, culturally rooted tools that develop rhythm, memory, language, listening, and numeracy skills through repetition, movement, and participation.
- Art and craft activities nurture creativity, fine motor development, expression, and self-identity, while promoting observation, aesthetic appreciation, and cultural connectedness.
- All forms of play—whether through conversation, stories, toys, music, or art—are deeply intertwined with literacy and numeracy learning, making abstract concepts meaningful and enjoyable.
- When teachers plan intentional, inclusive, and culturally relevant play-based experiences, children not only learn better but also develop a lifelong love for learning.



7.7 END EXERCISES

1. Define the concept of conversations and the two kinds of conversations that a teacher can use in classroom teaching.
2. State the importance of storytelling for children.
3. How can you use toy-based learning in your teaching?
4. Differentiate between drawing and painting.
5. Elucidate the concept and principles of play.

7.8 REFERENCES

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